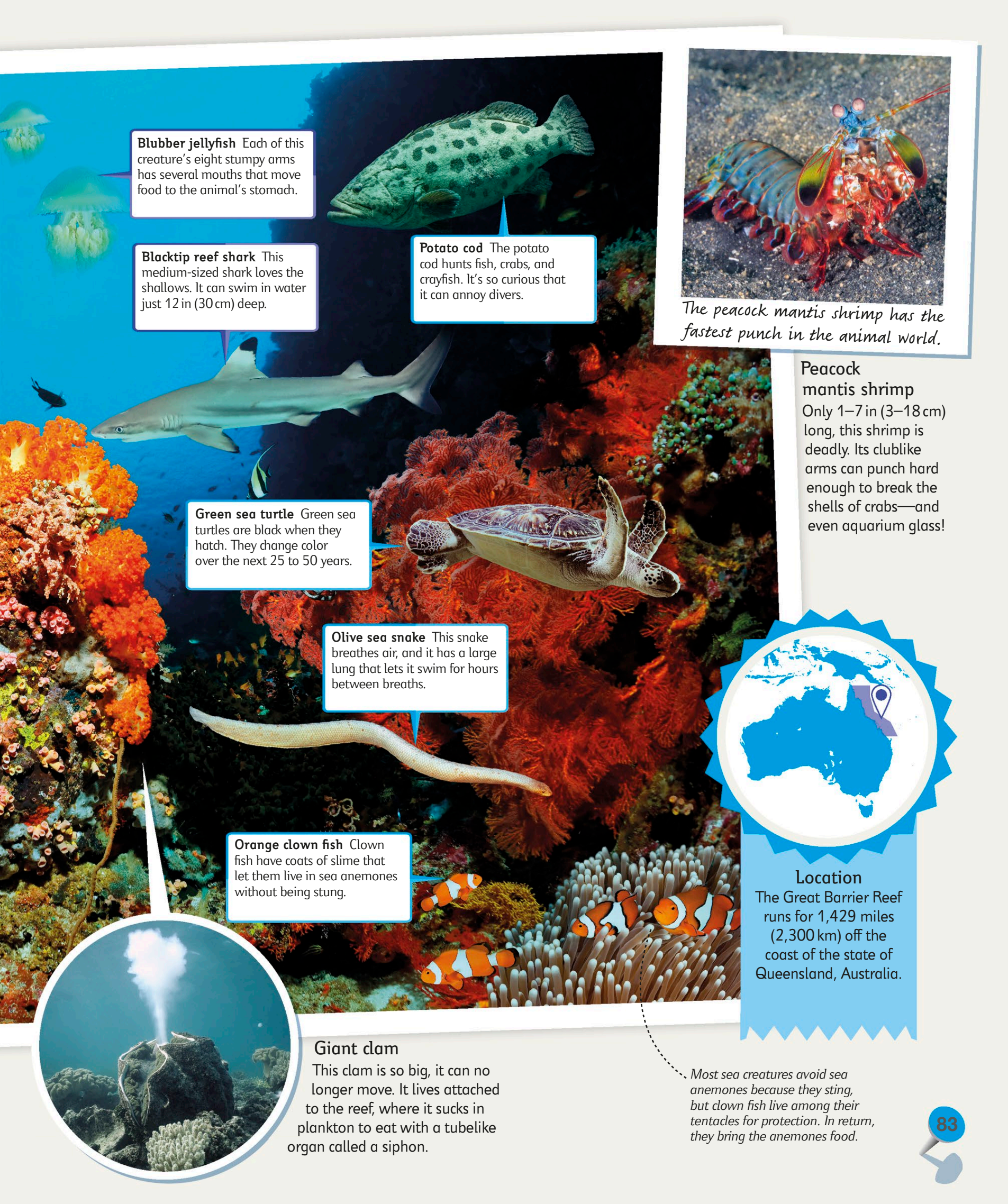




Blubber jellyfish Each of this creature's eight stumpy arms has several mouths that move food to the animal's stomach.

Blacktip reef shark This medium-sized shark loves the shallows. It can swim in water just 12 in (30 cm) deep.

Potato cod The potato cod hunts fish, crabs, and crayfish. It's so curious that it can annoy divers.

Green sea turtle Green sea turtles are black when they hatch. They change color over the next 25 to 50 years.

Olive sea snake This snake breathes air, and it has a large lung that lets it swim for hours between breaths.

Orange clown fish Clown fish have coats of slime that let them live in sea anemones without being stung.

Giant clam
This clam is so big, it can no longer move. It lives attached to the reef, where it sucks in plankton to eat with a tubelike organ called a siphon.



The peacock mantis shrimp has the fastest punch in the animal world.

Peacock mantis shrimp
Only 1–7 in (3–18 cm) long, this shrimp is deadly. Its clublike arms can punch hard enough to break the shells of crabs—and even aquarium glass!



Location
The Great Barrier Reef runs for 1,429 miles (2,300 km) off the coast of the state of Queensland, Australia.

Most sea creatures avoid sea anemones because they sting, but clown fish live among their tentacles for protection. In return, they bring the anemones food.